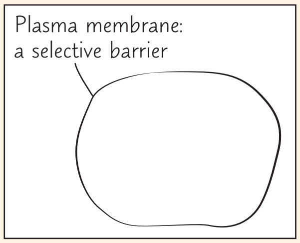
6 A Tour of the Cell

KEY CONCEPTS

Study Tip

Draw animal and plant cells: Draw an outline of an animal cell and add structures, labels, and functions. Draw a plant cell labeled with structures unique to plant cells.



Go to Mastering Biology

For Students (in eText and Study Area)
- Get Ready for Chapter 6
- Figure 6.7 Walkthrough: Geometric Relationships between Surface Area and Volume
- BioFlix® Animations: Tour of an Animal Cell and Tour of a Plant Cell

For Instructors to Assign (in Item Library)
- Tutorial: Tour of an Animal Cell: The Endomembrane System
- Tutorial: Tour of a Plant Cell: Structures and Functions

Figure 6.1 The cell is an organism's basic unit of structure and function. Many forms of life exist as single-celled organisms, such as the *Paramecium* shown here. Larger, more complex organisms, including plants and animals, are multicellular. In this chapter, we focus mainly on eukaryotic cells—cells with a nucleus.

How does the internal organization of eukaryotic cells allow them to perform the functions of life?

Internal membranes divide a cell, such as this plant cell, into compartments where specific chemical reactions occur.